Palmer and Perkins refer to propaganda as “any attempt to persuade persons to accept a certain point of view or to take a certain action” which has a specific aim and method of action.

Couloumbis and Wolfe[28] point out that propaganda has been effectively defined as a process involving a communicator whose attention is to change the attitudes, opinions and behaviour of a target population using spoken, written and behavioural symbols and employing media such as books, pamphlets, films, lectures and so on. They also project the disaggregation of the cooperative from the conflictual types of propaganda in terms of white, gray and black propaganda.

White Propaganda: It is referred to as those cooperative and straightforward campaigns designed to explain the policies of a state to audiences across its borders and over the seas. This generally involves activities in cultural and educational domains involving cultural and educational exchange programmes. Magazines, pamphlets, films and lectures are the usual methods of orchestrating the message for cultivation of mutually beneficial friendship and cooperation.

Gray Propaganda: It begins when the relationship between the communi-cator and the government of the target state begins to deteriorate. Therefore, exaggeration and falsehood creep into the communications and propaganda becomes combative and competitive in content and philosophy (of propaganda).

Black Propaganda: It usually refers to those techniques, that are used during the time of war when actual hostilities break out and diplomacy and formal negotiations fail. Verbal and audio-visual weapons are used in communication hiding the true identities of the communicators and producing forged and fabricated documentations aimed at creating confusion and chaos in the ranks of the enemy, for example, forecast for large-scale unemployment, food scarcity, labour, ethnic unrest, and famine.

According to Joseph Frankel, propaganda is generally understood as any systematic attempt to affect the minds, emotions, and actions of a given group for a specific purpose. Like diplomacy, it is also verbal, but it is different from diplomacy in two respects, though the dividing